

How SAT prep works here, and why it is set up this way

Your student practices on a program that works like the real test, gets a plan built from their own results, and is measured honestly along the way. This guide explains each piece in plain language.

Sundays

Lesson on one skill, then 30 minutes of practice.

Midweek

About 30 minutes of homework on that skill.

5th Sundays

A timed practice test to measure progress.

Every few weeks

A progress report like the one described below.

Getting started

1. **Add yourself.** On your tutor's home Wi-Fi, your student opens the practice site and signs up with their name and a 4-digit PIN.
2. **Find the starting point.** Either a **1-hour diagnostic** (a shortened, timed, adaptive practice test covering both sections), or, if they already have one, an **official SAT, PSAT, or Bluebook score**.
3. **Get a plan.** From that result, the program ranks every skill by how many points it is worth to this student right now, and the calendar fills in.

Help while practicing

Your student chooses how much help they want in each practice set:

Hint first. A wrong first try gets a hint and one more try, then the full explanation.

Show the answer. The explanation right after the first try.

Locked. Like the real test: explanations only at the end.

Only the first try counts toward the score estimate, whichever they pick, so hints never inflate the numbers.

The Digital SAT, in one page

Students take the SAT on a laptop or tablet in the College Board's Bluebook app. It has two sections, each split into two timed modules.

	Reading and Writing	Math
Questions	54 (two modules of 27)	44 (two modules of 22)
Time	64 minutes (32 per module)	70 minutes (35 per module)
What it looks like	Short passages, one question each: vocabulary in context, main ideas, evidence, grammar and punctuation, transitions.	Algebra, advanced math, data and statistics, geometry and trigonometry. About a quarter of answers are typed in rather than chosen.
Tools	Highlighter, cross-out, flag for review.	A built-in Desmos graphing calculator and a reference sheet, available the whole time.

It adapts. How a student does on the first module of each section decides whether the second module is harder or easier. Only the harder second module can lead to the highest scores. **Scores** run from 400 to 1600: 200 to 800 for each section. The whole test takes 2 hours and 14 minutes, plus a 10-minute break between sections. A few questions in each module are unscored trial questions.

Practice here copies all of this: the same module layout and timing, the same tools, and the same adaptive rule between modules. The questions are original, not College Board questions.

The score estimate: what it is, and what it is not

After enough practice, the program shows a **likely score range**, for example “1080 to 1180, most likely about 1130.” It is right about 80% of the time that the real score would fall in that range if the test were taken today.

Built to be honest

- Only first tries count.
- A blank answer on a timed test counts as wrong, just as on the real SAT.
- Untimed practice and practice on one topic count for less.
- No single skill can dominate: drilling one easy topic cannot produce a high score.
- Topics with little practice make the range wider, not rosier.
- Recent work counts more than old work.

What it is not

- Not an official score. The College Board does not publish exactly how it scores the SAT; this is a transparent statistical estimate.
- Not fixed: it moves as your student improves.
- Sharper with a real anchor. An official SAT or PSAT score, or a free **Bluebook practice test**, gives the estimate a solid starting point. Please share those scores with the tutor.

How the plan and calendar decide what comes next

Each student has their own calendar showing what they did, today, and what is planned. Every planned item comes with a one-line “why.” The rules are the same for everyone:

1. **Sundays are tutoring days.** The 1st to 4th Sunday of each month is a lesson and practice on one focus skill. A 5th Sunday is a timed, hour-long practice test that shows progress under real conditions.
2. **A starting point comes first.** Until there is a diagnostic result or an official score, the next session is the 1-hour diagnostic. Everything else is planned from it.
3. **Each lesson targets the most points available.** Every skill gets a priority: how much of its section it covers on the real SAT, times how often the student is missing medium-difficulty questions on it right now. The highest priority goes first.
4. **The plan keeps moving.** Once a skill has a lesson, its priority is halved for later weeks, so the next lesson moves on. If the skill is still weak later, it comes back. No more than two lessons in a row go to the same section, so both Reading and Writing and Math improve.
5. **Homework follows each lesson.** Midweek practice on the same skill, three days after the lesson, is what makes a new method stick.
6. **Slipping skills get a refresher.** If accuracy on a skill that used to be fine drops, a short refresher is added that week.

7. **The last weeks before the SAT are different.** About two weeks out there is a full-length practice test as a dress rehearsal. The final week is light review only, with no new material.
8. **It updates itself.** The plan is recalculated from the latest results every time it is opened, so it responds to how things are actually going. When something moves, the calendar says what changed and why.

A worked example: if a student gets only 4 in 10 medium punctuation questions right, and punctuation is about 13% of the Reading and Writing section, punctuation goes near the top of the list. After its lesson it drops down so the next skill gets a turn, and it comes back if it is still weak later.

Progress reports

Every few weeks your tutor can send a short report with:

- The current likely score range and how it has changed since the start.
- How much practice happened in the last 30 days.
- What is going well, and what the lessons are focusing on.
- The next four weeks of the plan, each with its reason.
- A personal note from the tutor.

How you can help at home

- Ask to see the Wednesday homework. About 30 focused minutes is the goal.
- Ask your student to explain one question they got wrong, and why the right answer is right.
- Protect sleep before practice tests and the real SAT.
- In the final week before the test: rest, light review, and a checklist. No new material.
- Encourage a free Bluebook practice test, and share the score with the tutor.

Privacy

Everything is stored on the tutor's own computer, not on a website or in the cloud. Students sign in with a first name and a 4-digit PIN; no email address or other personal information is collected. The only outside connection is the Desmos calculator used during Math. A student's records can be deleted at any time on request.

Common questions

Why is the score shown as a range instead of one number?

Because any single practice score has some luck in it. A range is the honest answer, and it narrows as more questions are answered.

My student's estimate went down this week. Is something wrong?

Usually not. Estimates move a little from session to session. What matters is the trend over several weeks, which the report shows as a line over time.

Why doesn't the plan just drill the weakest skill every week?

A skill that is rarely tested can be weak without costing many points. The plan weighs how often a skill appears on the real SAT as well as how often it is being missed, and it rotates so no area is neglected.

Are these real SAT questions?

No. They are original questions written to match the official format, content, and difficulty. For official practice, use the College Board's free Bluebook practice tests.

What happens if we miss a Sunday?

The tutor marks it on the calendar and the plan shifts forward. Nothing is lost.

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